is timeless, unchanging, permanent, self-sufficient and independent of anything else. Such an identity would be uncaused. Acceptance of essence implies the existence of types of entities. Each atomic factor has two modes of existence: actualised and non-actualised. Each exists with its nature or essence unchanging (***svabhava***) and independently of everything else in a timeless dimension, but the atoms are momentarily actualised as and in the cosmos, including the temporary streams of experiences that we all call persons. The patterns formed by the atoms lend themselves to our conceptually constructing a worldview involving individual, personal subjects of experience and the stable environment that they inhabit.

The *Abhidharma* writings differentiate those atomic factors that are spiritually unhelpful from those that are virtuous. Through insight one can remove defilements and approach enlightenment. The skilled meditator analyses his experiences into their fleeting components, thus dissolving the objects of attachment and eliminating desires for them. Through the same process he realises that there is no soul or permanent identity, just currents in an ocean of experiences.

See ***Vaibhashika***

Further reading: Frauwallner 1995; Potter 1996; Pruden 1988

Abhihita-anvaya-vada: the view of ***Kumarila*** and his followers that each individual word has its own innate meaning. When these meanings are combined in accordance with the rules of grammar, they produce the purport (*tatparya*) of the sentence. In isolation, words primarily express features shared by a group of entities: they refer to something specific when interrelated in sentences.

Further reading: Brough 1996b; Matilal 1990; Mohanty 1992